

Building a Practical Toolkit for Evaluating AI-Generated Language Teaching Materials

Workshop presented by Sarah Warfield

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June 22, 2026

International Summit on the

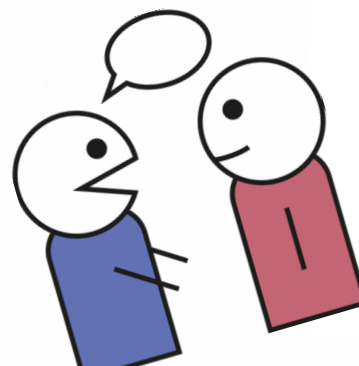
Use of AI in Language Learning and Teaching 2026 (AlinLT 2026)

Hong Kong, China



Outline

- Icebreaker 
- Background
- Activity 1: Starting your checklist
- Activity 2: Analyzing AI materials
- Activity 3: Refining your checklist
- Discussion throughout



By the end of the workshop, you will...



Walk away with a new tool for evaluating AI-generated materials



Think critically about AI-generated language learning tasks



Learn from your colleagues' experience with AI in the classroom



Be excited to use what you've built in your own teaching

You are welcome to take photos during today's presentation.



I will also share the slides and materials at the end.



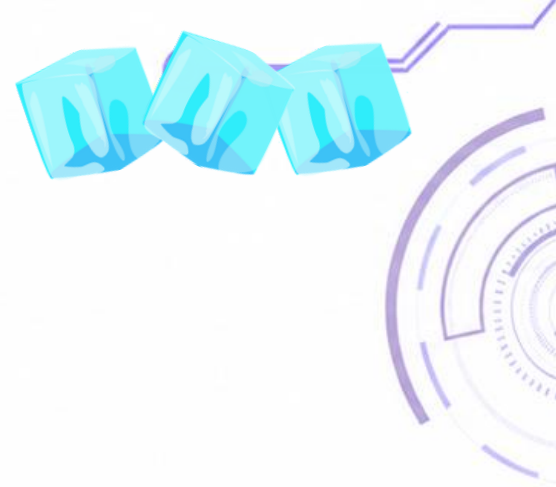
You are welcome to re-use and share these slides and activities at your school.

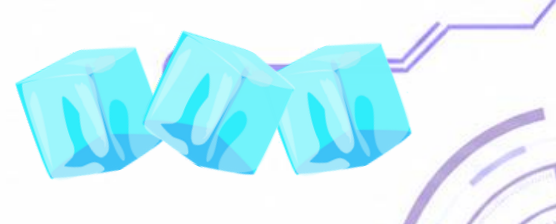


Icebreaker: Didn't Live Up to the Hype

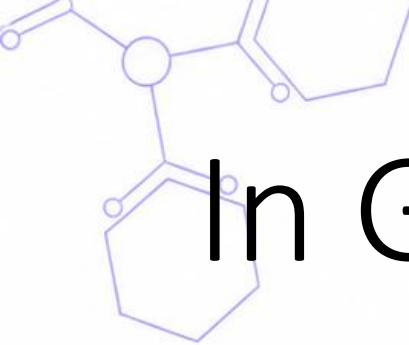
#17 Ordered A Beautiful Chrome Doberman Statue, Description Said 3ft Tall





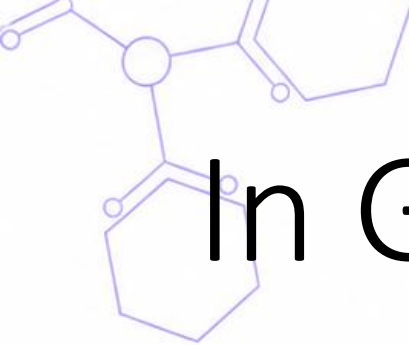






In Groups

- Say “hello” to everyone in your group.
 - Choose one person to be the moderator.
 - You will keep the group on task.
- 



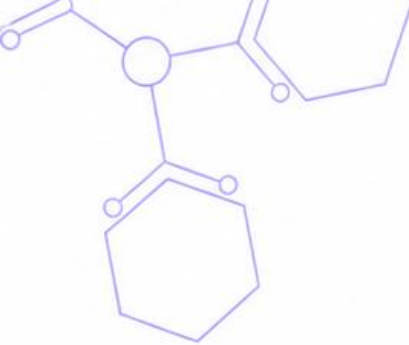
In Groups

- Think of a time you bought something online and what arrived was nothing like what you expected.
 - Use these starters: *"I ordered... but what I got was..."* or *"I thought it would be... but actually..."*
 - Everyone shares one story with the group.
 - **Moderator**, be sure everyone shares something.
 - *No shopping stories?* Think of a time something was not as good as you expected.
- 

All of these “shopping fails” are examples of a lack of **quality control**.

This is why we need **humans in the loop**.





Background

AI Use in Language Education



GROWING USE

AI tools are increasingly common in language education, with research documenting their use for lesson planning, materials development, assessment, feedback, and classroom support (Huang et al., 2023; Jiang, 2022; Zhou & Hou, 2025).



PREPARING TEACHING MATERIALS

62.5%

of EFL teachers in a study of 24 university teachers in China reported using AI to prepare teaching materials — updating courseware, generating syllabi, and creating discussion questions.

(Zhou & Hou, 2025)



UNESCO AI Competency Framework for Teachers

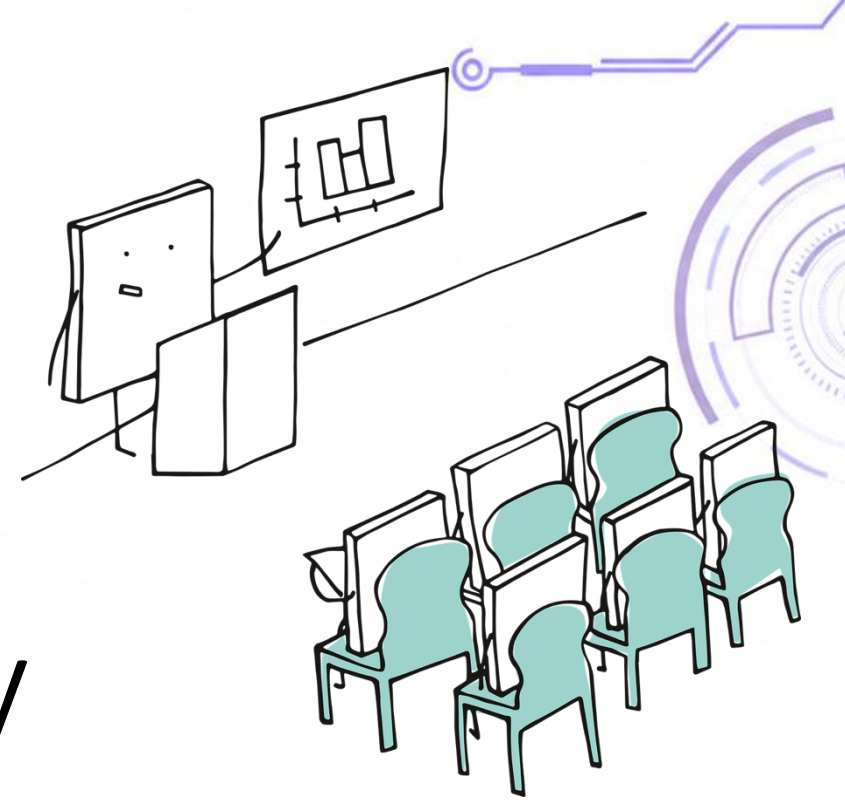


Table 1. The AI competency framework high-level structure: aspects and progression levels

Aspects	Progression		
	Acquire	Deepen	Advance
1. Human-centred mindset	Human-centred design	Human accountability	Social responsibility
2. Ethics of AI	Ethical principles	Safe and responsible use	Co-creating ethical rules
3. AI foundations and applications	Basic AI techniques and applications	Application skills	Creating with AI
4. AI pedagogy	AI-assisted teaching	AI-pedagogy integration	AI-enhanced pedagogical transformation
5. AI for professional development	AI enabling lifelong professional learning	AI to enhance organizational learning	AI to support professional transformation

When teachers skip application skills, they lose the ability to:

- Judge whether AI-generated content is accurate or appropriate
- Spot limitations or bias in what AI produces
- Make informed decisions about what to keep, adapt, or discard



AI TOOLS AREN'T VENDING MACHINES



They require
judgment, context,
and human expertise.



THINK



EVALUATE



ADAPT



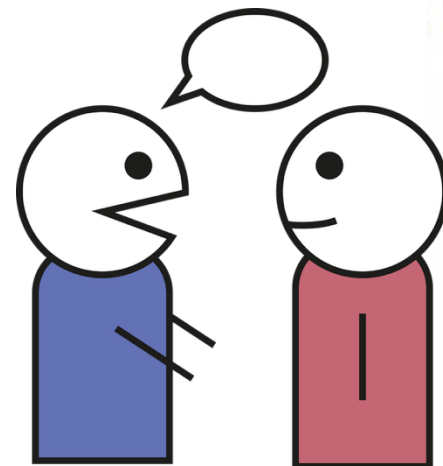
How you interact with AI matters

What do you think?

02:00

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- Turn to your neighbor
- Say *Hello!*
- How do you feel about using AI to generate language learning materials?
- *What do you think?*





Activity 1: Starting your checklist

Applying Your Checklist



1



Use the checklist in your initial prompt

Add your checklist criteria to your prompt when creating materials.



2



Interact with the AI tool using the checklist

Use the checklist to guide your conversation and refine the output before the final output.



3



Evaluate the final output against your checklist

Review the final materials using your checklist to ensure quality, accuracy, and alignment.



Prompting for AI materials



Proficiency level(s) of your learners



Classroom context



Type of task



Four strands of language teaching



Four Strands of Language Learning (Paul Nation)



Meaning-focused input

Reading and listening to comprehensible content slightly above students' current level. Focus is on understanding meaning, not on language forms.

Sample task: Read an article and answer comprehension questions.

When evaluating AI materials:

Is the text level appropriate? Does the task keep focus on meaning rather than form?



Meaning-focused output

Speaking and writing for communicative purposes. Students focus on conveying meaning rather than accuracy.

Sample task: Write an email to a friend describing a recent experience.

When evaluating AI materials:

Does the task give students a real communicative purpose? Or does it feel like a grammar exercise in disguise?



Language-focused learning

Deliberate attention to vocabulary, grammar, and pronunciation. Includes explicit instruction and practice.

Sample task: Identify and correct errors in a paragraph.

When evaluating AI materials:

Is the language focus clear and appropriate for the level? Are the examples accurate?



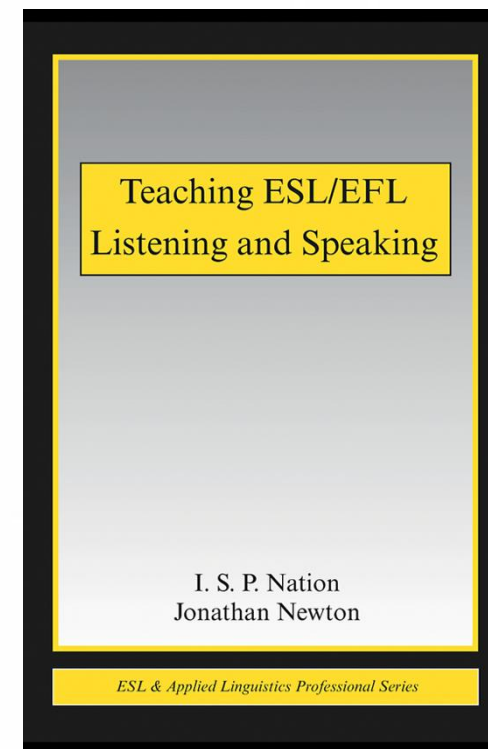
Fluency development

Repeated practice with familiar language to build speed and automaticity. Content should be easy so students can focus on performance.

Sample task: Retell a familiar story in two minutes.

When evaluating AI materials:

Is the content genuinely easy enough to allow fluency practice, or is it actually a new learning task?



About 25% of class time for each strand. Language-focused learning should not be more than 25%.

TWO PROMPTS

PROMPT 1

Create a writing task for B2 EFL students about rhetorical organization.

PROMPT 2

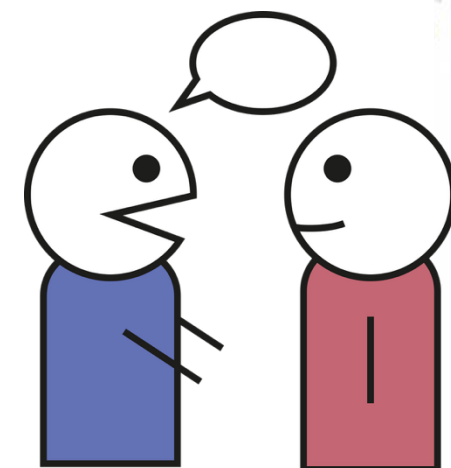
Create a writing task for B2-level EFL university students. The focus is rhetorical organization — specifically thesis statements and paragraph structure. Students have already practiced topic sentences and supporting evidence but struggle with writing clear, arguable thesis statements. This task will feed into a final assessed essay at the end of the unit. This is an afternoon class, so the task should be engaging and include a brief collaborative warm-up before individual writing. Students have 45 minutes.

02:00

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What do you think?

- Turn to your neighbor
- Say *Hello!*
- What makes a question useful when you're checking AI-generated materials?
- *What do you think?*



02:00

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- Work with one other group member
- Choose one person to be the *recorder*
- Brainstorm a list of questions you can use to review AI-created materials
- Try to write five



02:00

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In Groups

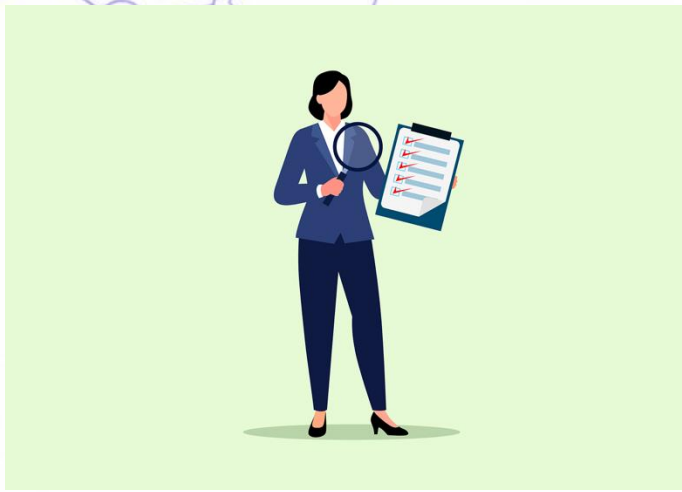
- Share your lists with the group.
- ***Moderator***, make sure everyone contributes
- Discuss: *What makes a good review question?*

02:00

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In Pairs

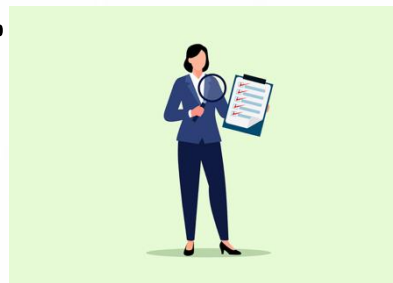
- Look at your list again
- Agree on your five final questions
- Write them at the top of your poster



Activity 2: Analyzing AI materials

In Pairs

- Using your five questions as criteria, evaluate the AI-generated materials at your table and record your findings on your poster.



Analyzing AI Materials

Question 1	
Question 2	
Question 3	
Question 4	
Question 5	

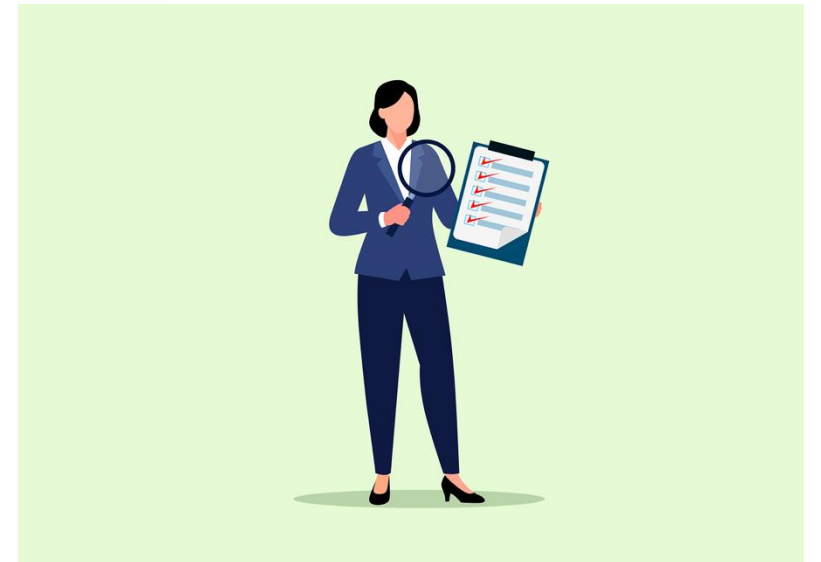
Task One :	
1	
2	
3	
4	
5	

Task Two:	
1	
2	
3	
4	
5	



In Groups

- Share your posters with the group.
- ***Moderator***, make sure everyone contributes

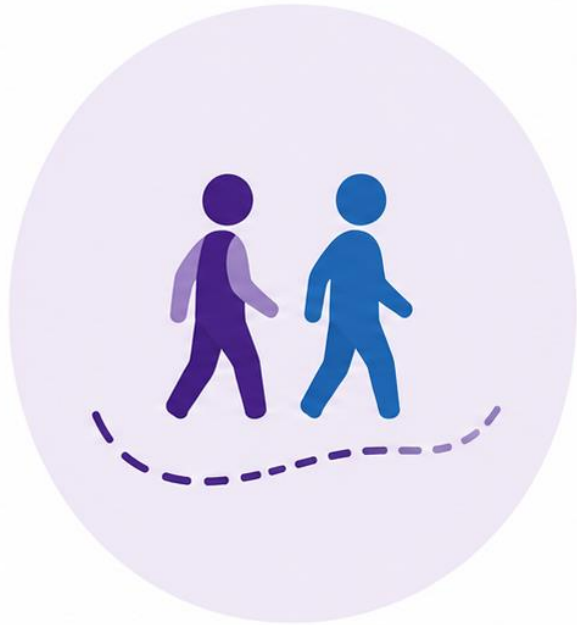


Gallery Walk



- Has anyone used a gallery walk in their classroom before?
- Effective for large classrooms
 - Students can see each others' work
- Effective for formative assessments
 - Easy to check on student progress in a low-stakes way
- Great for learning!
 - Movement and blood flow support cognition

Gallery Walk



**Travel
in pairs**



**Choose one
recorder**



**Spend two
minutes at
each poster**



**Use the stickers
to leave comments
on the work of
your peers**



Activity 3: Refining your checklist

AI & Quality Control



AI **learns** what a lesson plan looks like, not what language learning is



It can **reproduce the structure** of a good lesson



It **does not understand** why balance across strands matters



It **does not know** that fluency comes from meaningful, repeated use



It **does not know** that form-focused tasks work best when connected to real communication



Pair Work

Work with your partner to discuss the comments from the gallery walk.

Which comment surprised you most?

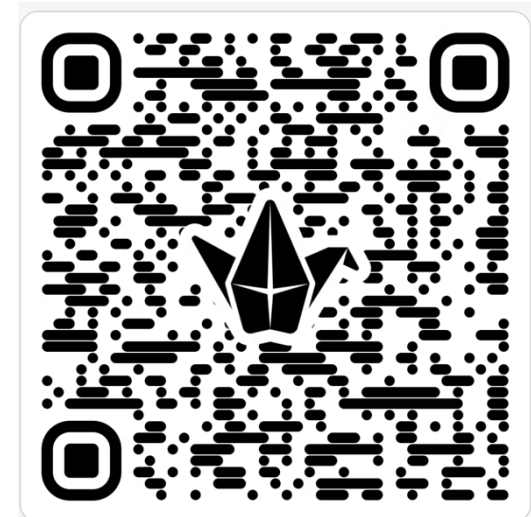
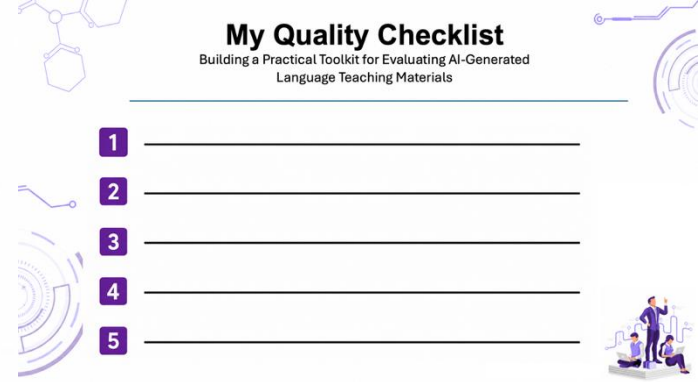
Is there a question on your list that didn't work as well as you thought?

What's one thing you want to add or change based on the feedback?

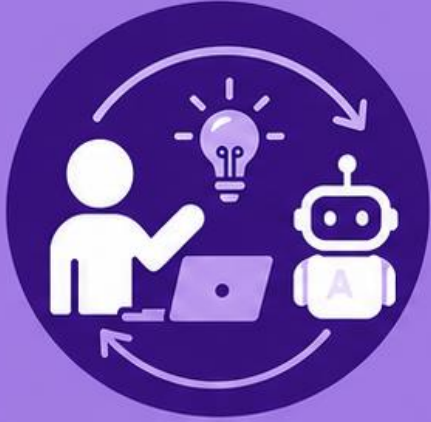


Individual Work

1. Fill in **My Quality Checklist**
2. Upload a picture to our Padlet
Checklist + selfie (optional)
3. Leave comments on other teachers' Final Checklist Certificates



In Conclusion



GenAI is a powerful new digital tool in our teaching toolkit—but we must keep humans in the loop.



As AI in education becomes more normalized, we can act as guides and decision makers on how AI is applied in our own classrooms.



We should engage more with the **process** of AI rather than the **product** to ensure best outcomes for ourselves and the students we teach.

By the end of the workshop, you will...



Walk away with a new tool for evaluating AI-generated materials



Think critically about AI-generated language learning tasks



Learn from your colleagues' experience with AI in the classroom



Be excited to use what you've built in your own teaching

Thank you!

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Today's Slides and Materials



Works Cited

Huang, X., Zou, D., Cheng, G., Chen, X., & Xie, H. (2023). Trends, research issues and applications of artificial intelligence in language education. *Educational Technology & Society*, 26(1), 112–131.

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